GRADE 3

Curriculum Book

Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 3 - Curriculum Book

What I can do, what I love, and what I notice - that's where ideas live. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

Year theme: *Business ideas come from skills, hobbies, and needs* ***Grade band:*** *3-5 (upper-elementary, math arrives)* ***Total instructional time:*** *~36 weeks · 60–75 minutes per week (one block plus a short follow-up)* ***Anchor mascot:*** *Cash, the program's animated host*

Where ideas come from

Skills, hobbies, needs - and the eyes to notice.

Why this year

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

Eight- and nine-year-olds are starting to notice that they can *do* things. One can draw. One reads chapter books. One can ride a bike with no hands and explain how. One quietly fixes the jammed pencil sharpener every morning. They know what they are good at, even when they cannot name it. They also know what bugs them — the messy cubbies, the kid who never has a pencil, the dog walker who keeps losing the leash. Grade 3 takes those two muscles — *I can do this* and *this is broken* — and shows students how to put them together. That is where business ideas come from.

The financial spine of the year is **cost, revenue, and profit** for one simple scenario: a lemonade stand. We use whole-number prices on purpose. We stay in dollars. We add and subtract and multiply because that is what 3rd graders are learning to do anyway. By June a Grade 3 student can say: "*My can of lemonade mix costs $4. I made 16 cups. I sold each cup for $1. That is $16. Sixteen minus four is twelve. I made twelve dollars of profit.*" That sentence is a big deal.

The classroom spine is **the team of three.** Most Grade 3 work happens in trios with named roles — CEO, designer, money keeper, sales — that rotate through the year. Working in a trio is a skill. Hearing your teammate say "I think we should change the price" is a skill. Saying "okay, why?" instead of "no" is a skill.

This is the first year of the 3-5 band. It bridges K-2's picture-first noticing into upper-elementary math, writing, and design. Grade 2 ended with students filling out a "Problem → Idea" card. Grade 3 picks that up and asks, *what if the idea came from you — from something you can do, something you love, or something you keep noticing?*

The big ideas (Understanding by Design — Stage 1)

TRY THIS

Spot it in the wild

Walk through your house. Find three things somebody made or sold. Write the name of one. Who do you think bought it, and why?

These are the year's understandings. Every unit, every lesson, and every Cash video traces back to one or more.

1. **A business idea is a match.** It matches something you can do, or love, or keep noticing — to somebody who would be glad you did it.
2. **Generating ideas is a skill, not a flash of luck.** Five ideas beats one idea every time. Pick the most real-sounding one, and say why.
3. **Profit is what's left.** Money in, minus money out, equals what's left. If what's left is more than zero, the business made money that day.
4. **A logo and a name are messages.** They tell the customer something before you say a word.
5. **A business runs in steps, in order.** Open. Sell. Restock. Close. Count. Clean. Skip a step and something breaks.
6. **Honest sells longer.** "100% juice" and "juice drink" are not the same. Customers come back to the one that told the truth.
7. **First tries get something wrong. That is normal.** The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.

Essential questions (returned to all year)

WORDS TO KNOW

Skill
Something you have practiced enough to be good at.

Hobby
Something you do for fun, on your own time.

Need
A problem somebody has that they want solved.

Customer
The person who pays - not the person you wish would pay.

Idea
A skill, a hobby, or a need turned into a way to help someone.

- What can I do that somebody else might pay for?
- You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?
- What does it cost me, and what do I get back?
- What does my logo tell the customer before I open my mouth?
- What goes in what order, and what happens if I skip a step?
- Is this honest, or is it just clever?
- What did I get wrong on Day 1, and what would I do differently?

Year-at-a-glance

MATH MOMENT

Tally five

Ask five people: 'Would you buy this?' Tally yes and no with marks. Five marks each row. Did more say yes or no?

The year is built as four units. Each unit ends with an artifact and feeds the rolling Capstone — the *Skill-and-Need Stand* — that students design across the year.

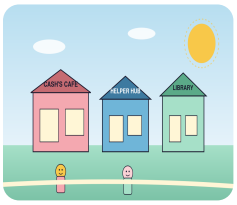
UNIT	WEEKS	TITLE	BIG IDEA	ANCHOR ARTIFACT
1	1–8	Skills, hobbies, needs	Business ideas come from a match.	A Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web with two circled business ideas.
2	9–18	Five ideas from one problem	Generating ideas is a skill.	A 5-idea page with the chosen idea defended in writing.
3	19–27	The lemonade math + the logo	Profit is what's left; a logo is a message.	A cost/revenue/profit worksheet plus a hand-drawn logo and business name.
4	28–36	Run the day, tell the truth, fix the flop	Run in steps, sell honestly, learn from the first try.	A 4–6 step run-of-day list, an honesty check, and a "first-try fix" reflection.

The **Capstone (the Skill-and-Need Stand)** threads all four units. Students choose a hypothetical business in Week 4 — a service, a product, an event, a help — and develop it across the year. On Capstone Day in Week 36, each trio sets up a 3-foot table with their logo, their cost/revenue/profit numbers, their run-of-day list, and a 90-second pitch. Families and a guest classroom (older grade, ideally Grade 4) walk the room and ask one question per stand.

Vocabulary roadmap (15–20 terms)

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real customers

Family, neighbors, classmates, teachers, the person at the corner store. Five real people beats one good guess.

Vocabulary in Grade 3 is concrete and recycled. New terms are added with a picture and a simple example. Students keep a Vocabulary Spine page in their workbook — a single growing list. A Frayer-style square (definition · example · non-example · picture) is built for the four anchor terms: **customer, problem, plan, profit.**

Unit 1 (skills, hobbies, needs): *skill, hobby, need, customer, idea, web (idea web), match.*

Unit 2 (idea generation): *brainstorm, problem, evidence, real-sounding, defend.*

Unit 3 (lemonade math + logo): *cost, revenue, profit, price, logo, name, message.*

Unit 4 (run, honest, fix): *plan, step, honest, misleading, first try, fix.*

Anchor four (Frayer-square required): **customer, problem, plan, profit.**

Anchor texts and media

FAMILY TALK

Skill, hobby, or need?

At dinner, name one skill, one hobby, and one need somebody at the table has. Could any of them turn into a tiny business?

Mix of read-alouds, picture-rich nonfiction, and short video. None require purchase; school-friendly substitutes are listed.

- *The Lemonade War* (Jacqueline Davies) — read-aloud or excerpt for Unit 3. Surfaces pricing and rivalry without modeling cruelty.
- *Last Stop on Market Street* (Matt de la Peña) — Unit 1 noticing-the-helpers re-read; bridges K-2 to 3-5.
- *What Do You Do With an Idea?* (Kobi Yamada) — Unit 2 launch.
- *One Plastic Bag* (Miranda Paul) — Unit 4 honesty + first-try fix; a real entrepreneur in The Gambia who turned a problem into a business.
- A short Cash video per unit-launch and unit-close (8 across the year — see the Video Scripts file).
- One labeled, kid-friendly product label compared to a misleading one (a "100% juice" vs. "juice drink" pair) — provided in the program assets.

Project arc — the Skill-and-Need Stand (Capstone)

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

Each trio (or pair, in smaller classes) builds one stand across the year. A stand can be a service (dog walking, cubby clean-up, chapter-book read-aloud), a product (bracelet, slime, painted rock), a content idea (a how-to mini-zine), or a helper job (recess equipment manager). The Capstone has four checkpoints:

- **End of Unit 1 (Week 8):** Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web, with two circled ideas.
- **End of Unit 2 (Week 18):** 5-idea page; one chosen idea with a written reason ("I picked this because…").
- **End of Unit 3 (Week 27):** Cost/Revenue/Profit worksheet for one day of running the stand, plus the logo + name.
- **End of Unit 4 (Week 36):** Run-of-day list, honesty check, first-try fix reflection — and the Capstone Day stand itself.

Students choose the venture (with their trio) in Week 4, from a teacher-curated list of "Capstone-friendly" categories. Optional pivot windows in Weeks 9 and 19 let trios switch if evidence demands.

The 8 strand outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

STRAND	OUTCOME (BY END OF 3)
BAVC	I can complete a "Skills + Hobbies + Needs I See" web with at least 3 entries each, and circle two business ideas it suggests.
PSIG	I can generate at least 5 business ideas from a single problem prompt and pick the most "real-sounding" one with a reason.
MFL	I can calculate cost, revenue, and profit for a simple lemonade-stand scenario with whole-number prices.
CBM	I can draw a logo and choose a name for my business idea and tell what each communicates to a customer.
OSO	I can list the 4–6 steps of running my business idea (open, sell, restock, close, count, clean) in order.
LTO	I can take a role (CEO, designer, money keeper, sales) on a 3-person team and describe what my role does.
ESL	I can tell whether a business example is honest or misleading (e.g., "100% juice" vs. "juice drink") and give one reason.
LRCI	I can describe one thing a "first try" business got wrong in a Cash story, and one fix the entrepreneur made.

Standards alignment (the year actually centers)

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4:** People can earn income by working for others or themselves (entrepreneurship).
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-2:** Use a basic decision-making process to make a choice.
- **CCSS-Math 3.OA.D.8:** Solve two-step word problems using the four operations — used for cost/revenue/profit.
- **CCSS-ELA W.3.1:** Write opinion pieces — students defend their picked idea.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize.
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1:** Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want.
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** Identify one's own skills and interests.

Honest gap: the program teaches *logo as message* and *team-of-three roles* as core moves. Neither is named in the K-12 financial-literacy benchmarks. We teach them anyway because they are how real Grade 3 entrepreneurs work, and because picking a name and choosing your job on a tiny team are skills.

Assessment philosophy

We assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the student do the work the strand outcome names?** (Did they actually generate five ideas? Did they actually compute profit?)
2. **Can they explain why?** (Why this idea? Why this price? Why this name?)

The 4-point rubrics in the Rubric Bank are the spine. At Grade 3 we use the elementary-band scaling: **Business Plan Rubric** (4 criteria, no operations or self-assessment criterion), **Customer Research Rubric** (3 criteria), **Reflection Writing Rubric** (full 4 criteria, simplified language). Holistic scoring is allowed for Cash-video reflections; analytic scoring is required for the four Capstone checkpoints.

Differentiation across Grade 3

- **ELL.** Use sentence frames everywhere. "*My skill is* ***_. My idea is . My customer is*** *__.*" Allow native-language brainstorming on the idea web; require English on the final artifact. Pair students who share a home language for the team-of-three when possible. Pre-teach the four anchor terms (customer, problem, plan, profit) with picture cards before each unit.
- **IEP/504.** Allow drawing as primary mode for the idea web and the run-of-day list. Voice-record the 5-idea defense if writing is slow. Pre-print the cost/revenue/profit worksheet with one example already filled in. Extended time on Capstone Day to set up the stand.
- **Advanced.** Push for evidence even at this grade — "*how would you ask three kids if your idea is real?*" Push for a second pricing scenario — "*what if you only sold 8 cups instead of 16? Recompute profit.*" Have advanced students serve as Vocabulary Spine helpers — they explain new words to the class with their own example.

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **Family money.** Never ask "how much does your family spend on lemonade ingredients?" or "do you have a Costco membership?" Use the framing "*for a hypothetical lemonade stand, the can of mix costs $4.*" Numbers come from the worksheet, not from home.
- **Skills as worth.** Some students will say "*I'm not good at anything.*" Coach the move: every Grade 3 student has at least one skill or hobby. The skill might be "I can listen to my little brother when he is upset" or "I always remember to feed the class fish." Those count. Push past the first shrug.
- **Need-naming and judgment.** "Needs I see" is a useful prompt. It can also tip into judging classmates ("she always loses her pencil"). Surface the difference between a *need-as-business-idea* (a pencil rental shelf) and *naming a kid's flaw.* No names on the web.
- **The lemonade stand and food safety.** If a real stand is run, clear it with families and the school first. Use store-bought, sealed ingredients. Hand-washing routine is non-negotiable. The program does not require an actual stand to run — paper version is fine and is the default.

Materials and tools (year)

- Notebooks (paper or digital) for the Vocabulary Spine and Capstone Journal — *Grade 3 Capstone Journal* template provided.
- Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web template (provided).
- 5-idea page template (provided).
- Cost/Revenue/Profit worksheet — whole-number version (provided).
- Logo + name worksheet, with a 4-inch square for the drawing (provided).
- Run-of-day strip — 6 numbered boxes (provided).
- "Honest or Misleading" sort cards — 12 cards (provided).
- Access to one Cash short video per unit-launch and unit-close (8 total).

- Optional: chart paper, markers, sticky notes for whole-class brainstorms.

How this year hooks into the rest of Cash to Company

- **Reaches back to Grade 2.** Grade 2 ended with the "Problem → Idea" card and the *fair to the customer* check. Grade 3 takes those cards and asks: *whose skill could turn this into a business? whose hobby?* The Day-1 web in Lesson 1 is a deliberate echo of the Grade 2 card.
- **Reaches forward to Grade 4.** Grade 4's theme is *businesses need a simple plan.* The 5-question Reality Check (*Who buys? How much? How many? What does it cost me? What's left?*) is exactly the math and customer reasoning Grade 3 sets up. Strong Grade 3 work — especially the cost/revenue/profit worksheet and the reasoned idea defense — is what makes Grade 4's 1-page plan template feel like the next step instead of a leap.
- **Vertical strands.** Each of the eight strands has a Grade 3 outcome listed above. The four units braid them together — Unit 1 is mostly BAVC + PSIG + CASEL self-awareness; Unit 3 is mostly MFL + CBM; Unit 4 is mostly OSO + ESL + LRCI; LTO threads through every unit because the team-of-three is the classroom default all year.

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You don't need to have run a business to teach this. You need to be willing to model two moves: noticing your own skill out loud ("*I am good at remembering everyone's name. That is a skill.*"), and asking *which people, and how do you know?* every time a student says "kids will love it." The Cash videos take some pressure off introducing concepts. The lesson plans take pressure off pacing. The math is friendly — whole numbers, no decimals, no margins. By Week 12 your students will be asking each other *what's your*

evidence? in the words of an 8-year-old. That is the win. Cash never says it that loud, but Cash means it: this is the year a kid figures out that they have something somebody might want.

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 3

Multi-class branching scenario — "Maya and the friendship bracelets"

A 3-day branching scenario for Unit 3 (the lemonade math + the logo).

- **Day 1.** Read aloud: "*Maya is in third grade. She loves making friendship bracelets. She has 30 cords, 200 beads, and 50 little tags. She wants to start a business. The cords cost $6, the beads cost $4, the tags cost $2. She wants to sell to second-graders.*"

Class question: "*Should Maya charge money for the bracelets, or trade them for something second-graders have?*" Pair-share. Three students share, each with a different vote.

- **Day 2.** Run the math both ways.

Money path. Cost per bracelet: cord $0.20 + beads $0.10 + tag $0.04 = $0.34. If she sells at $1 each, profit per bracelet = $0.66. If she sells 20, profit = $13.20.

Trade path. Maya trades a bracelet for a sticker. She has 30 stickers at the end. Did she "make money"? No. But she gained 30 stickers and lost $0.34 × 30 = $10.20 worth of materials. Surface: trades have a cost too.

- **Day 3.** Class discussion: "*Which path is better for Maya, and why?*" Each trio defends a recommendation in 60 seconds. Answer: depends on what Maya wants — money, stickers, both. The skill is naming the tradeoff.

This scenario practices PSIG, MFL (cost/revenue/profit), CBM (customer = second-graders), and ESL (is the trade fair?). Repeatable with: a kid who bakes cookies for cousins, a kid who walks dogs for neighbors.

Cross-grade bridge — preview to Grade 4

At the end-of-year showcase, mention to families: "*Next year, your child will take an idea like this one and put it on a one-page plan with a $50 budget cap. Grade 3 builds the math; Grade 4 builds the plan.*"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim)

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-3:** "Describe entrepreneurship and how people start small businesses."
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4:** "People can earn income by working for others or themselves (entrepreneurship)."
- **Jump$tart Standard 6 (Financial Decision Making), Benchmark 4-2:** "Use a basic decision-making process to make a choice."
- **CCSS-Math 3.OA.D.8:** "Solve two-step word problems using the four operations" — used for cost/revenue/profit.
- **CCSS-ELA W.3.1:** "Write opinion pieces" — students defend their picked idea.
- **C3 D2.Eco.10.3-5:** "Explain why individuals, businesses, and governments specialize."
- **NGSS-ETS 3-5-ETS1-1:** "Define a simple design problem reflecting a need or a want."
- **CASEL Self-Awareness:** "Identify ones own skills and interests."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Strand Outcomes (verbatim)

By end of Grade 3, a student can: - **BAVC:** "I can complete a Skills + Hobbies + Needs I See web with at least 3 entries each, and circle two business ideas it suggests." - **PSIG:** "I can generate at least 5 business ideas from a single problem prompt and pick the most real-sounding one with a reason." - **MFL:** "I can calculate cost, revenue, and profit for a simple

lemonade-stand scenario with whole-number prices." - **CBM:** "I can draw a logo and choose a name for my business idea and tell what each communicates to a customer." - **OSO:** "I can list the 4–6 steps of running my business idea (open, sell, restock, close, count, clean) in order." - **LTO:** "I can take a role (CEO, designer, money keeper, sales) on a 3-person team and describe what my role does." - **ESL:** "I can tell whether a business example is honest or misleading (e.g., 100% juice vs. juice drink) and give one reason." - **LRCI:** "I can describe one thing a first try business got wrong in a Cash story, and one fix the entrepreneur made."

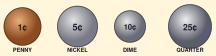
ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Grade 3) — including the "great-idea-no-skills-yet" persona

- **Skills/Hobbies/Needs extension:** Add a fourth column — *Skills I want to learn*. The "great idea, no skill yet" student maps the gap and names one skill theyd build first.
- **Profit extension:** Compute profit at *three* sales volumes (e.g., 5 cups, 10 cups, 20 cups) and identify the volume that breaks even. Seed of Grade 8 break-even.
- **Logo extension:** Design two logos for the same business — one for kids, one for adults. Discuss why the same business needs two looks.
- **Trio extension:** Take the *fourth* role — sales — and run the customer interaction while the three internal roles are running.
- **The "great-idea-no-skills-yet" persona prompt:** "I have a great idea but no skills yet. What do I do first?" Answer: name the *one* skill youd build, the *one* person youd ask for help, and the *one* week youd need to learn it. This persona prevents the "I cant start a business because I have no skills" misconception.

FROM CASH

What I do, what I love, what I notice

Three questions. Three sentences. Three ideas. That's how a business starts - not with a logo, with a list.



KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 3 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 3-5
Spending and saving - earning money, choices, opportunity cost.

CEE NS3
Productive resources, scarcity, and choice.

CCSS-MATH 3.MD
Measurement and data - survey customers, tally results.

CCSS-ELA SL.3.1
Engage in collaborative discussions - pitch and feedback.

CASEL Self-Awareness
Identify strengths, interests, and values.

C3 D2.Eco.1.3-5
Compare benefits and costs of choices.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"

- CASH, GRADE 3

You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it? — Cash

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